



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Belmont Classical Academy
School Website: <https://thecarmans.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Belmont Classical Academy Utah (84003) presents no publicly evident alignment with the classical education paradigm as defined by the Six Essential Elements. Based on the school's crawl content, the publicly visible material emphasizes online learning and technology rather than core classical-historical markers such as the Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, liturgical or communal practices, or strong partnerships with families as co-educators. The available public material appears to describe a digitally oriented learning offering rather than a classical-paideia program. This assessment relies on the Belmont crawl item that centers on "Online Learning and Testing" and "Our Technology," with no clear indicators of classical formation, Great Books, or scholé pedagogy within the public-facing materials.

Using the knowledge-base rubric for classical education (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School), the absence of explicit evidence for the six categories yields a NOT CLASSICAL classification across all six categories. Positive keywords associated with classical education (e.g., truth, virtue, great books, scholé, liturgy, Socratic dialogue, etc.) are not visible in the Belmont materials retrieved from the crawl. The rubric's Positive Keyword indicators come from the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)" document, which defines the core signals of classical orientation (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; great books; worship/liturgical rhythm; Great Conversation; Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; formation of affections; partnership with families; etc.).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Belmont materials visible in the crawl emphasize online learning and technology rather than transcendental foundations, theology, liturgical practices, or communal worship.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords identified; 0 negative keywords identified (no explicit classical religious metaphysical signals present in the Belmont crawl excerpt). No explicit references to theology, liturgy, or sacred practices were observed in the available Belmont crawl snippet. The Six Essential Elements positive keyword lists emphasize terms like truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, etc., which are not evidenced in the Belmont crawl content.
 - Why this rating: Without theological framing, liturgical practice, or transcendentals present in Belmont's public materials, the school fails to meet the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria. The rubric requires transcendental realism or liturgical/community elements to score Classical in this category.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public Belmont content highlights online learning rather than formation toward virtue/wisdom apart from vocational aims. No explicit paideia/formation language (virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty as teleology) is visible in the crawl excerpt.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords; 0 negative keywords observed in the Belmont content excerpt (no "formation" vocabulary aligned with classical purposes).
 - Why this rating: The Six Elements framework foregrounds formation toward virtue and wisdom (not simply job-readiness). Belmont's visible materials do not demonstrate that teleology in the

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- sense of truth, goodness, and beauty as enduring ends.
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The Belmont crawl content centers on online-learning language (Online Learning and Testing) rather than a curriculum built around grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; or a Great Conversation. No explicit Trivium/Quadrivium or Great Books program is visible in the publicly crawled Belmont content.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords; 0 identified negative signals tied to classical curriculum in the Belmont material excerpt. The classical curriculum signals (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation) are not present in the crawl excerpt.
 - Why this rating: Absent indicators of a classical liberal-arts curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric; great books; history as study of Western civilization) leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Belmont content in the crawl emphasizes online learning and testing rather than Socratic seminars, lectures in a classical format, memory work, or scholé-based restfulness. No explicit reference to Socratic dialogue, structured debates, or rhetoric-based pedagogy is visible in the excerpt.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords; 0 explicit negative signals for classical pedagogy (no explicit statements of non-classical pedagogy either) in the Belmont crawl excerpt. The absence of classical teaching-method signals (Socratic seminars, recitation, memorization, disciplined memory practices, etc.) is notable.
 - Why this rating: Without Socratic discussion, memorization practices, or rests-and-contemplation rhythms described in classical pedagogy, the Belmont public materials do not align with the Pedagogy criterion.
 - Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The Belmont crawl excerpt does not present a descriptive profile of faculty as living curriculum, mentors, or model teachers; it centers on online learning infrastructure rather than teacher formation or faculty as exemplars.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords; 0 identified explicit signals about faculty in classical terms in the crawl excerpt. The Positive Keywords in the Classical Elements highlight teachers as models of virtue and living curriculum; not evidenced in the Belmont crawl snippet.
 - Why this rating: Absence of a described faculty identity as virtuous mentors or living curriculum constitutes a NOT CLASSICAL alignment.
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The Belmont crawl excerpt focuses on online learning infrastructure, with no clear statements about parental partnership, co-educator roles, family formation, or community liturgical/civic activities. The absence of explicit parent partnership signals results in NOT CLASSICAL for this category based on the visible material.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: 0 positive keywords; 0 explicit signals of parent/community partnership in the Belmont crawl excerpt. The Six Elements keyword lists emphasize Partnership with Families and Community; not evidenced here.
 - Why this rating: Without partnership with families or adult formation signals, Belmont does not satisfy the Parents & Community criterion.

Overall Aggregate Assessment: NOT CLASSICAL

- The combined image across all six categories indicates Belmont Classical Academy Utah, as evidenced by the crawl content available, does not meet the classical criteria set forth in the Six Essential Elements documents. The absence of explicit classical signals—great books, scholé, liturgical practices, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic pedagogy, and explicit family-partnership elements—in the public materials leads to a NOT CLASSICAL overall classification.

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL schools only) - Not applicable here, as the aggregate rating is NOT CLASSICAL. If moves were contemplated, they would include: adopting a classical liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books), instituting Socratic seminars and Paideia-style

discussions in upper grades, incorporating rest-based scholé pedagogy, embedding liturgical/community practices, establishing formal partnerships with families, and building a living curriculum centered on virtuous instruction.

Element-by-Element Detail

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Belmont crawl content emphasizes online learning and technology rather than transcendental or liturgical foundations (no explicit theology or sacred practice references in the visible material).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: none (no references to truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, etc., in the accessible Belmont material).
 - Negative keyword signals observed: none explicitly present in the Belmont excerpt (no explicit signaling of secular or relativistic drift in the public text). The absence is itself an indicator that this category lacks classical signals.
- Why this rating
 - The Six Elements rubric foregrounds transcendental foundations (truth, goodness, beauty) and liturgical/community practice as central signals. The Belmont crawl excerpt does not evidence these, yielding a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The visible Belmont content centers on online-learning infrastructure rather than formation toward virtue, wisdom, or classical telos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: none in the accessible Belmont text.
 - Negative keyword signals observed: none explicitly; the lack of classical formation language is the signal here.
- Why this rating
 - Classical purpose emphasizes formation toward virtue and wisdom (teleology toward truth, goodness, beauty). The Belmont content does not demonstrate that orientation as part of its stated goals.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Belmont crawl content is oriented to online learning and testing; there is no explicit mention of liberal arts, grammar/logic/ rhetoric, Great Books, Latin/Greek, or a Great Conversation approach.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: none (no Great Books; no mention of the liberal arts or Trivium/Quadrivium).
 - Negative keyword signals observed: none explicitly; the lack of classical curriculum signals is the signal.
- Why this rating
 - Without a classical curriculum core (grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; Western civilization history through a classical lens), the category cannot be scored Classical.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

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- The Belmont crawl emphasizes online learning, not the classical pedagogies (Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation, scholé days).
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: none.
 - Negative keyword signals observed: none; however, absence of classical pedagogy signals yields NOT CLASSICAL by default.
 - Why this rating
 - The lack of classical teaching-method signals (Socratic experimentation, disciplined memory work, rest-based pedagogy) results in a NOT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public Belmont materials do not present a living-curriculum or faculty-as-mentors narrative; the visible content centers on infrastructure rather than faculty ethos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: none.
 - Negative keyword signals observed: none; absence of living-curriculum or mentor-model language.
- Why this rating
 - Without a faculty profile that models virtue and acts as the living curriculum, this category does not meet classical signals.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The crawl excerpt shows no explicit emphasis on parental partnership or community liturgical/educational formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: none.
 - Negative keyword signals observed: none; no explicit parental-partnership language in the visible Belmont materials.
- Why this rating
 - The Six Elements framework highlights parents as co-educators and a vibrant community; these signals are not visible in the current Belmont crawl excerpt.

What Would Move the Needle

- Concrete steps to move toward CLASSICAL (for a school currently NOT CLASSICAL):
 - Adopt a classical liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with a schedule that includes Great Books and primary sources; reframe history as Western civilization through the Great Conversation.
 - Implement scholé-based pedagogy (restful learning, contemplative time) and incorporate Socratic discussion in upper grades.
 - Introduce liturgical/community practices (shared sacred time, liturgical calendar, communal rituals) and integrate theology as a centerpiece of curriculum (Mistress Science orientation).
 - Build a robust faculty profile as living curriculum: model virtue, mentorship, and collegiality; articulate a clear teacher-student formation framework.
 - Establish formal partnerships with families (parents as co-educators), parent formation programs, and open campus opportunities; invite parental involvement in school governance, curriculum planning, and liturgical activities.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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